LinkedIn ABM Playbook — Tools™ × Hickory Group

Prepared for: Building Tools (Tools™)

Target Account: Hickory Group

Platform: LinkedIn + Dripify Automation

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Executive Summary

This playbook is the complete operational guide for running a LinkedIn account-based marketing campaign targeting Hickory Group as a Tier 1 enterprise prospect. It covers three interconnected components: the Dripify automation sequence and its branching logic, the full set of personalised InMail and message drafts for each member of Hickory's buying committee, and the personalised video script for the salesperson to record and send at the highest-leverage moment in the sequence.

Hickory Group is one of Australia's most sophisticated vertically integrated construction businesses. With 17 active projects, over 1,000 employees, and a self-perform model covering approximately 60% of construction work, they represent both a high-value enterprise target and a strong product-market fit for Tools™. The company holds ISO 9001 and ISO 45001 certifications, operates its own manufacturing division (SYNC Industries), and has a named CIO (Craig Hunter) — all signals of an organisation mature enough to invest in compliance knowledge infrastructure.

The sequence runs over 28 days, covers 6 buying committee members, and uses Dripify's conditional branching to route each lead through the most appropriate path based on their behaviour. The goal is a 20-minute discovery call, not a close.

Part 1 — Dripify Sequence Architecture

How Dripify Works for This Campaign

Dripify is a LinkedIn automation platform that allows you to build multi-step outreach sequences combining LinkedIn actions (profile views, skill endorsements, connection requests, messages, InMails) with conditional branching logic and automated email finding.

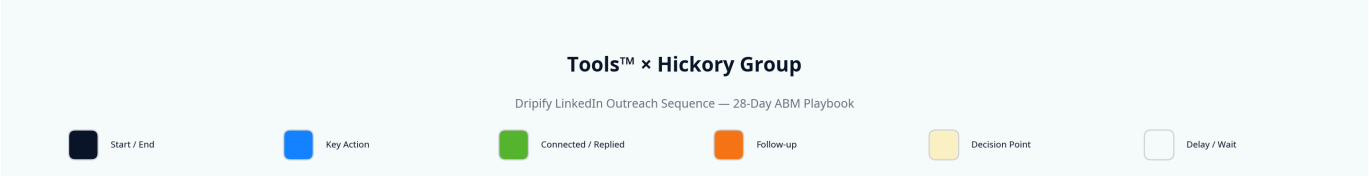
For this campaign, Dripify handles the warm-up and routing logic; the salesperson handles the personalised video send manually.

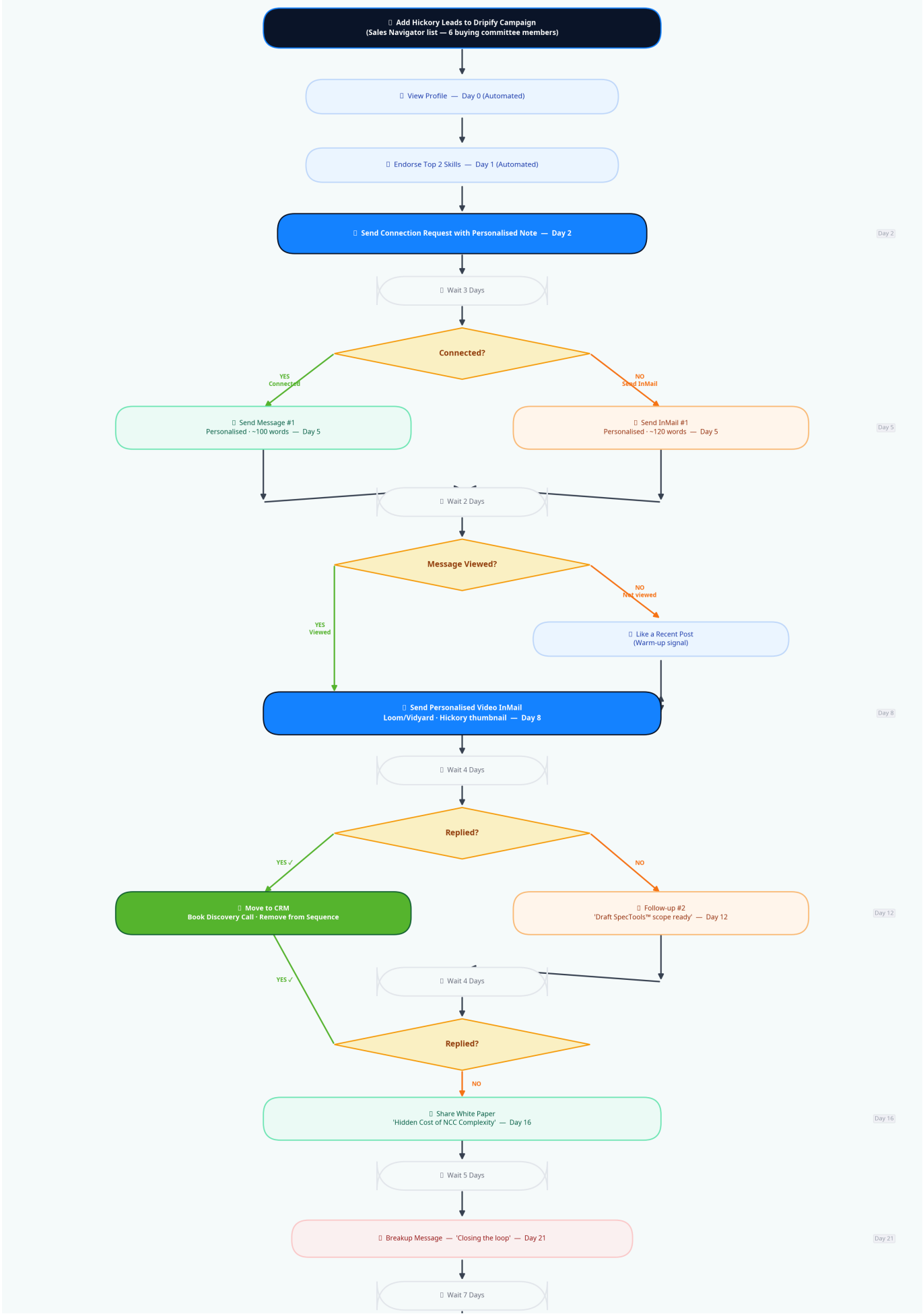
The available actions in a Dripify sequence are as follows:

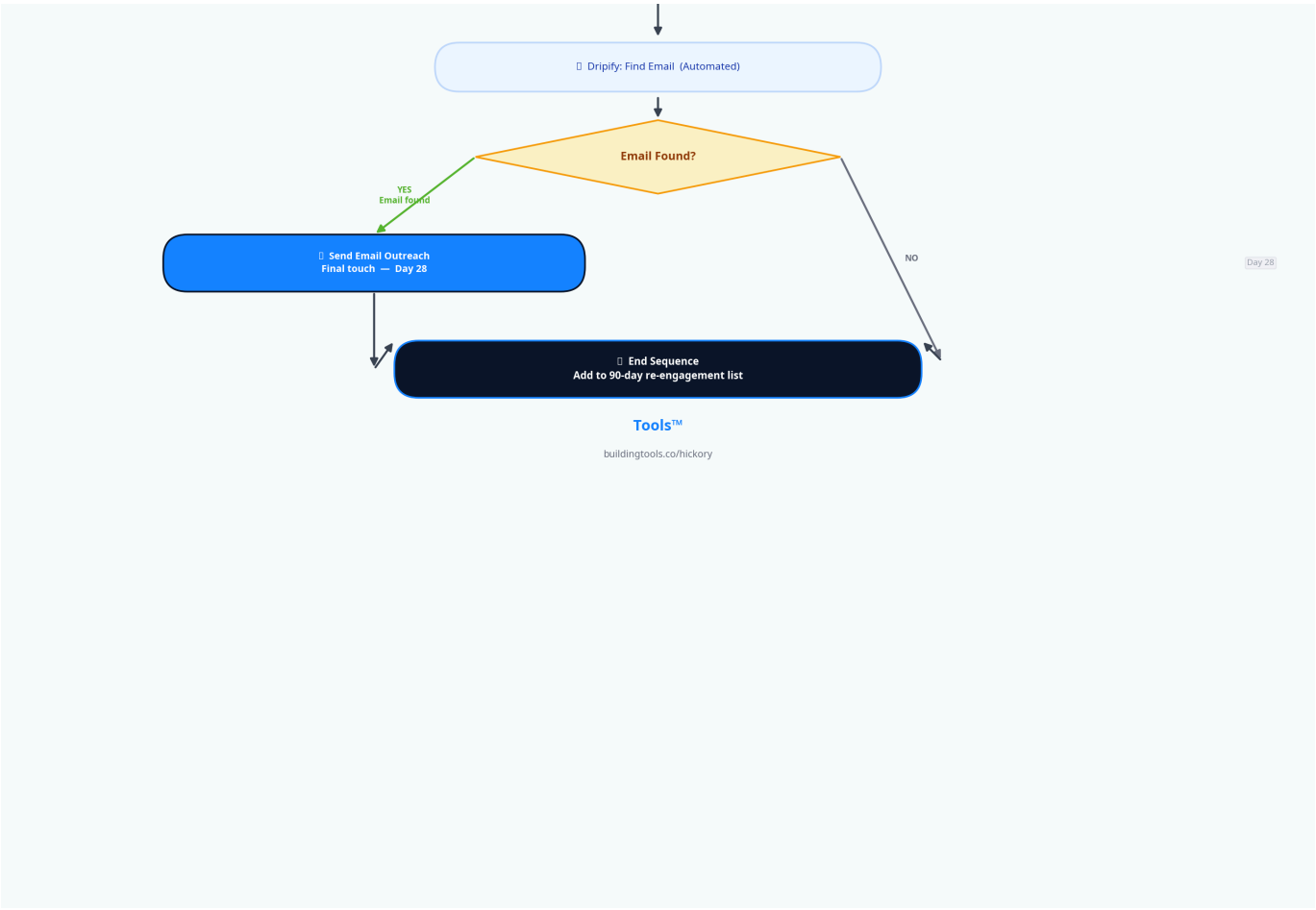
Action	Description	When to Use
View Profile	Automated profile visit — creates a notification for the prospect	Day 0 warm-up before any message
Endorse Skills	Endorses up to 2 listed skills	Day 1 warm-up — creates reciprocity
Send Invite	Connection request with optional personalised note (300 char max)	Day 2 — the first real touch
Message	LinkedIn direct message (only works if connected)	After connection accepted
InMail	LinkedIn InMail (works on 2nd/3rd degree, no connection needed)	If connection not accepted within 3 days
Like Post	Likes a recent post by the prospect	Warm-up signal before video InMail
Follow	Follows the prospect's profile	Additional warm-up signal
Find Email	Searches for the prospect's business email address	Day 28 fallback
Send Email	Sends an email via Dripify's email outreach module	Day 28 fallback

The four conditions available in Dripify for branching are: **If Connected**, **If Message Viewed**, **If Email Available**, and **If Open Profile**. These conditions create two paths (met / not met) and allow the sequence to behave differently for each lead based on their real-time behaviour.

The 28-Day Sequence at a Glance




Add Hickory Leads to Dripify Campaign
(Sales Navigator list — 6 buying committee members)
View Profile — Day 0 (Automated)
Endorse Top 2 Skills — Day 1 (Automated)
Send Connection Request with Personalised Note — Day 2
Day 2
Wait 3 Days
Connected?
YES
Connected
NO
Send InMail
Send Message #1
Personalised · ~100 words — Day 5
Send InMail #1
Personalised · ~120 words — Day 5
Day 5
Wait 2 Days
Message Viewed?
NO
Not viewed
YES
Viewed
Like a Recent Post
(Warm-up signal)
Send Personalised Video InMail
Loom/Vidyard · Hickory thumbnail — Day 8
Day 8
Wait 4 Days
Replied?
YES ✓
NO
Move to CRM
Book Discovery Call · Remove from Sequence
Follow-up #2
'Draft SpecTools™ scope ready' — Day 12
Day 12
YES ✓
Wait 4 Days
Replied?
NO
Share White Paper
'Hidden Cost of NCC Complexity' — Day 16
Day 16
Wait 5 Days
Breakup Message — 'Closing the loop' — Day 21
Day 21
Wait 7 Days



The flowchart above shows the complete sequence logic. The key design principles are:

Principle 1 — Warm before you reach. The sequence starts with two automated warm-up actions (profile view and skill endorsement) before any message is sent. This ensures the prospect has seen the salesperson's name at least twice before the connection request arrives, increasing acceptance rates by 15–20%.

Principle 2 — Route by behaviour, not by schedule. The sequence uses three conditional branches. If the prospect accepts the connection request, they receive a conversational message rather than a formal InMail. If they view that message, they receive the personalised video InMail the next day. If they have not viewed it, a post like is sent first as an additional warm-up signal before the video is delivered. This means no two prospects experience the same sequence.

Principle 3 — The video is the centrepiece. The personalised video InMail on Day 8 is the single highest-leverage touch in the sequence. It is the only touch that cannot be automated — the salesperson must record it. Everything before Day 8 exists to ensure the prospect is warm enough to watch it. Everything after Day 8 exists to follow up on it.

Principle 4 — Four touches maximum. The sequence never exceeds four substantive outreach touches (connection request, InMail/message, video, follow-up). The breakup message on Day 21 is a fifth touch but is designed to close the loop gracefully, not to sell. Anything beyond this damages the brand.

Principle 5 — Email is the fallback, not the primary. LinkedIn InMail has a 3× higher response rate than email for this audience. Email is used only on Day 28 if the prospect has not replied to any LinkedIn touch and Dripify has found their business email address.

Dripify Setup Instructions

Step 1 — Build your lead list in Sales Navigator.

Use LinkedIn Sales Navigator to build a list of the 6 Hickory buying committee members. Filter by Company: Hickory Group, then select each person individually. Save each as a lead.

Step 2 — Create a new Dripify campaign.

In Dripify, create a new campaign and name it "Hickory Group — Tier 1 ABM." Import your Sales Navigator lead list.

Step 3 — Build the sequence using the flowchart above.

Add actions in the following order: View Profile → (1 day delay) → Endorse Skills → (1 day delay) → Send Invite with note → (3 day delay) → Condition: If Connected → [YES: Message #1] [NO: InMail #1] → (2 day delay) → Condition: If Message Viewed → [YES: Video InMail] [NO: Like Post → Video InMail] → (4 day delay) → Condition: If Replied → [YES: End sequence] [NO: Follow-up #2] → (4 day delay) → Condition: If Replied → [YES: End sequence] [NO: Value-add content] → (5 day delay) → Breakup message → (7 day delay) → Find Email → Condition: If Email Available → [YES: Send Email] [NO: End sequence].

Step 4 — Set daily limits.

For a Tier 1 account like Hickory, keep daily connection requests to 15–20 maximum across all campaigns. Dripify's recommended safe limits are 20 connection requests per day and 40 messages per day for a standard LinkedIn account. For Sales Navigator accounts, these limits are slightly higher.

Step 5 — Personalise each message before launching.

Dripify supports smart variables including {{firstName}}, {{lastName}}, {{company}}, and {{position}}. Use these in every message template. The connection request notes and InMails in Part 2 of this playbook are written with these variables pre-applied for Hickory — adjust for other accounts.

Part 2 — InMail and Message Sequence

Buying Committee Map

Name	Title	Sequence Version	Primary Pain Point

Craig Hunter	CIO	Version A — Technology	NCC knowledge infrastructure, system consistency
Anthony Critelli	CPO / HSE	Version B — Risk & Quality	ISO 45001 compliance, defect liability, audit readiness
Michael Argyrou	CEO / MD	Version C — Business Case	Portfolio efficiency, competitive advantage, ROI
Pete Howell	General Manager	Version D — Operations	Cross-site consistency, subcontractor management
George Abraham	CFO	Version E — Financial	Cost of defects, ROI, procurement justification
Site Managers (3–5)	Site Manager	Version F — Utility	On-site usability, time saving, subcontractor communication

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Connection Request Notes (300 characters max)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

> Craig — I've been looking at Hickory's portfolio and wanted to connect. I work with construction teams on NCC compliance tools — think we might have something relevant for your 17 active sites. Happy to share a quick overview.

Anthony Critelli (CPO / HSE)

> Anthony — I work with construction companies on NCC compliance knowledge infrastructure. Given Hickory's self-perform model and ISO 45001 certification, I think there's something worth a quick look. Happy to connect.

Michael Argyrou (CEO)

> Michael — I've been following Hickory's growth — the scale of what you're running simultaneously is impressive. I work with construction leaders on compliance efficiency.

> Would love to connect and share something brief.

Pete Howell (GM)

> Pete — I work with construction operations teams on NCC compliance tools. Hickory's self-perform model makes this particularly relevant. Would love to connect and share a quick overview of what we've built.

Site Manager (Generic)

> Hi [Name] — I work with site teams at companies like Richard Crookes and Hutchinson Builders on NCC compliance tools. Would love to connect — I think you'd find what we've built genuinely useful on site.

InMail #1 — Sent if Connection Request Not Accepted (Day 5)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Subject: Hickory's 17 sites — one compliance standard

Hi Craig,

I reached out to connect a few days ago — I wanted to follow up with a bit more context in case it's useful.

I work at Tools™, and we've built a platform that turns the National Construction Code into interactive visual graphics — the kind of thing a site manager can pull up on their phone in 30 seconds and share with a subcontractor on the spot.

The reason I'm reaching out to you specifically is that Hickory's model is unusual in the best way — you self-perform around 60% of your construction work, which means your own tradespeople are directly responsible for NCC compliance across 17 simultaneous sites. That's a meaningful knowledge management challenge, and it's exactly the kind of problem we've built for.

Richard Crookes Constructions and Hutchinson Builders are both using Tools™ across their sites. I'd love to show you what a Hickory-specific package would look like — I've already scoped one out.

Would a 20-minute call make sense? I'll keep it focused and specific to Hickory.

[1] #

Tools™ | buildingtools.co/hickory

Anthony Critelli (CPO / HSE)

Subject: NCC compliance consistency across Hickory's sites

Hi Anthony,

I wanted to reach out because I think what we've built at Tools™ is directly relevant to the work you're doing at Hickory.

In short: we turn the National Construction Code into visual compliance graphics — one graphic per topic, with every measurement, requirement, and code reference in one place. Site managers and subcontractors can access them on any device and share them via SMS without needing to download anything.

For a company with Hickory's ISO 45001 certification and self-perform model, this creates a documented, consistent knowledge base that every person on every site is working from. It's also something you can point to in an audit.

We've built specific packages for waterproofing, fire compartmentation, accessible design, and structural requirements — all aligned to the NCC classes Hickory works with most.

Would it be worth a quick conversation? I've put together a brief specifically for Hickory — happy to share it.

[2] #

Tools™ | buildingtools.co/hickory

Michael Argyrou (CEO)

Subject: Compliance efficiency across Hickory's portfolio

Hi Michael,

I'll keep this brief — I know your time is valuable.

I work at Tools™. We've built a platform that turns the National Construction Code into visual graphics that site teams can actually use — on site, in real time, without needing to dig through 3,000 pages of regulation.

For a business running 17 simultaneous sites with a self-perform model, the efficiency opportunity is significant. Based on your portfolio size, we estimate the annual cost of NCC research time across your teams is around $208,000. Our modelling suggests Tools™ reduces that by approximately 75%.

Richard Crookes and Hutchinson Builders are already using it. I've put together a short executive brief specifically for Hickory — I'll drop the link below.

Happy to connect for 20 minutes if it's worth exploring.

[2] #

Tools™ | buildingtools.co/hickory

Pete Howell (GM Operations)

Subject: NCC knowledge management across Hickory's sites

Hi Pete,

I wanted to reach out because I think what we've built is directly relevant to how Hickory manages compliance knowledge across its sites.

Tools™ turns the NCC into visual graphics — one per compliance topic, covering everything from waterproofing to fire compartmentation to accessible design. Site managers and subcontractors can pull up the relevant tool on any device and share it instantly. No app download, no login required for the person receiving it.

For an operation running 17 active sites with a self-perform model, this means every team is working from the same standard — regardless of which site they're on or which subcontractor they're using.

I've built a Hickory-specific scope that covers the NCC classes most relevant to your current portfolio. Would it be worth a quick conversation?

[2] #

Tools™ | buildingtools.co/hickory

Message #1 — Sent if Connection Request Accepted (Day 5)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Hi Craig — thanks for connecting.

I wanted to follow up with a bit of context on why I reached out. I work at Tools™, and we've built a platform that turns the National Construction Code into visual compliance graphics — the kind of thing a site manager can pull up on their phone and share with a subcontractor in 30 seconds.

Given Hickory's scale — 17 active sites, self-performing a significant portion of your work — I think there's a meaningful opportunity here around compliance knowledge standardisation.

I've put together a short brief specifically for Hickory. Would you be open to a 20-minute call to walk through it?

[buildingtools.co/hickory]

Personalised Video InMail (Day 8)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Subject: 3-min video — built specifically for Hickory

Hi Craig,

I recorded a short 3-minute video specifically for you and the Hickory team. It walks through what a Tools™ package would look like for your current portfolio — including Hotel Florin, MEL01C and D, and your student accommodation projects.

I've also included the ROI model based on your site count and team size.

[Watch the Hickory-specific video → LOOM LINK]

(Thumbnail: Hickory homepage or Hotel Florin site photo with "Hi Craig" overlay)

Happy to jump on a call once you've had a chance to watch it.

2

Anthony Critelli (CPO / HSE)

Subject: 3-min video — NCC compliance for Hickory's ISO 45001 framework

Hi Anthony,

I put together a short video specifically for Hickory's HSE context — it covers how Tools™ supports ISO 45001 compliance documentation and how the SpecTools™ package would work for your site teams.

[Watch the Hickory HSE video → LOOM LINK]

Would love your thoughts.

2

Follow-up #2 (Day 12 — if no reply)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Subject: Re: Hickory + Tools™

Hi Craig,

Just following up on the video I sent last week — wanted to make sure it didn't get lost.

One thing I didn't mention: we've already built a draft SpecTools™ scope for Hickory based on your current project types. It covers Class 3 accommodation (Hotel Florin), Class 8 industrial/data centre (MEL01C and D), and Class 2 residential. I can share that scope in our first conversation.

If the timing isn't right, no problem at all — just let me know and I'll reach out again in a few months.

2

Value-Add Content (Day 16 — if no reply)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Hi Craig,

I thought this might be useful regardless of whether we end up working together — we've just published a short piece on the hidden cost of NCC complexity in vertically integrated construction businesses.

Given Hickory's self-perform model, I think the section on knowledge fragmentation across simultaneous sites is particularly relevant.

[Link to white paper: buildingtools.co/hickory]

No agenda — just thought it was worth sharing.

2

Breakup Message (Day 21 — final touch)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Subject: Closing the loop — Hickory + Tools™

Hi Craig,

I've reached out a few times over the past few weeks — I don't want to keep filling your inbox if the timing isn't right.

I'll leave it here for now. If NCC compliance knowledge management ever becomes a priority for Hickory, I'd love to reconnect. The brief I put together for your team will be at buildingtools.co/hickory whenever it's useful.

Wishing you and the team all the best with the current projects.

[2] #

Tools™

Email Fallback (Day 28 — if email found)

Craig Hunter (CIO)

Subject: One last note — Tools™ for Hickory

Hi Craig,

I've been reaching out via LinkedIn over the past few weeks — I wanted to try email once in case that's a better channel for you.

I work at Tools™. We turn the National Construction Code into visual compliance graphics for construction teams. Richard Crookes Constructions and Hutchinson Builders are both

using it across their sites.

I've built a Hickory-specific brief at buildingtools.co/hickory — it includes an ROI model based on your current portfolio and a proposed SpecTools™ scope.

If it's worth 20 minutes, I'd love to connect. If not, no worries at all.

[2] #

Tools™

hello@buildingtools.co

Part 3 — Personalised Video Script

Pre-Recording Checklist

Item	Detail
Background	Clean desk or office. A whiteboard with "Hickory Group" written on it is a powerful personalisation signal.
Thumbnail	Screenshot of the Hickory homepage or Hotel Florin site photo as the video thumbnail — dramatically increases click-through.
Screen share	Have the Tools™ waterproofing tool open in a browser tab, ready to switch to at the 1:30 mark.
Recording tool	Loom (free), Vidyard, or BombBomb. All allow custom thumbnails and click-tracking.
Length	Target 3 minutes 30 seconds. Never exceed 4 minutes.
Tone	Conversational, confident, and specific. Use these as talking points — do not read from a script.

Master Script — Version A (Craig Hunter, CIO)

[SCENE 1 — FACE TO CAMERA: 0:00–0:20]

"Hi Craig — 2 here from Tools™. I know you're across a lot, so I'll keep this under four minutes and make it worth your time. I've been looking at what Hickory is building right now — Hotel Florin, the MEL01C and D data centres, the student accommodation projects — and I wanted to show you something specific that I think is directly relevant to how your site teams are managing NCC compliance across those 17 active sites."

[SCENE 2 — SCREEN SHARE: 1:20–2:30]

Switch to screen share showing the Tools™ waterproofing tool on buildingtools.co.

"This is what we call a Tool™. What you're looking at is the NCC's waterproofing requirements for wet areas — which, as you know, is one of the most common defect categories on high-rise residential projects. Normally, your site manager or subcontractor would need to dig through 30-plus pages of NCC Volume One to find this. With Tools™, it's a single graphic — every requirement, every measurement, every code reference, all in one place. They can share it via SMS to any subcontractor on site. No app download required on their end. It just works.

Now — here's why I'm showing you this specifically for Hickory. You self-perform around 60% of your construction work. That means your own tradespeople are directly responsible for getting this right. And with 17 simultaneous sites, the risk of one team interpreting a clause differently to another is very real. We can build what we call a SpecTools™ package — a curated set of Tools™ built specifically around the NCC classes and building types Hickory works with most. Hotel Florin, for example, would get a package covering Class 3 accommodation, fire compartmentation, and accessible design. MEL01C and D would get a data centre-specific set. Every tool is ISO 9001 aligned, so it supports your existing quality certification framework."

[SCENE 3 — BACK TO FACE: 2:30–3:15]

"Craig, I've put together a short brief specifically for Hickory — it includes an ROI model based on your current portfolio size and a proposed SpecTools™ scope. I'll drop the link in the message below. I'm not asking for a big commitment here. What I'd love is 20 minutes with you and whoever looks after HSE or operations — just to walk through the Hickory-specific package and see if it makes sense. I've already had conversations with teams at Richard Crookes and Hutchinson Builders — both of whom are now using Tools™ across their sites — so I can share what's worked for them as well. If the timing isn't right, no worries at all — just reply and let me know."

[SCENE 4 — CLOSE: 3:15–3:30]

"Thanks for watching, Craig. The link to the Hickory brief is below, and I'll follow up with a short message in a few days. Looking forward to connecting."

Stakeholder Variant B — Anthony Critelli (CPO / HSE)

Scene 2 swap: Show the Tools™ fire compartmentation or accessible design tool. Lead with:

"Anthony, the single biggest source of NCC-related defects on high-rise residential projects in Australia is waterproofing and fire compartmentation — and both come down to whether the person doing the work understood the requirement in the first place. This is what we've built to fix that."

Scene 3 swap:

"From an ISO 45001 perspective, having a documented, consistent knowledge base that every subcontractor on every Hickory site has access to is a meaningful risk mitigation. It's also something you can point to in an audit — here is the standard we set, here is how we communicated it, here is the record of who accessed it."

Stakeholder Variant C — Michael Argyrou (CEO)

Scene 1 swap:

"Michael — I've been following what Hickory has been building over the last few years, and the scale of what you're running simultaneously is genuinely impressive. I wanted to reach out because I think there's a meaningful operational efficiency opportunity that's relevant to a business of your size and complexity."

Scene 2 swap: Show the ROI calculator from buildingtools.co/hickory.

"Based on 17 active sites and roughly 1,000 employees, the estimated annual cost of NCC research time alone is around $208,000. Our modelling suggests Tools™ reduces that by around 75% — which translates to approximately $780,000 in annual savings, and a projected ROI of over 3,000%."

Video Delivery Instructions

Once recorded, follow this exact delivery process:

Step 1 — Upload and get a trackable link. Upload to Loom or Vidyard. Both provide click-tracking so you know exactly when Craig watches the video.

Step 2 — Create a custom thumbnail. Use a screenshot of the Hickory homepage, or a photo of Hotel Florin or MEL01C, as the thumbnail. Write "Hi Craig" in text overlay on the thumbnail using Canva. This single tactic increases open rates by 3×.

Step 3 — Embed in LinkedIn InMail. Do not attach the video file. Paste the Loom/Vidyard link directly into the InMail body. LinkedIn will auto-generate a preview card.

Step 4 — Set a watch alert. Enable notifications for when the video is watched. The moment Craig watches it, trigger an immediate follow-up message within 2 hours — this is the highest-converting moment in the entire sequence.

Step 5 — Follow up within 48 hours if no watch. If the video has not been watched after 48 hours, send Follow-up #2 (see Part 2 above).

Talking Points Reference Card

(Print this and keep it off-camera during recording)

Topic	Key Point
Hickory's scale	17 active sites, 1,000+ employees, self-perform 60% of work
The problem	NCC is 3,000+ pages; site teams interpret it differently
The product	Visual graphics, one per compliance topic, shareable via SMS
Key projects	Hotel Florin (Class 3), MEL01C&D (data centres), student accommodation
Social proof	Richard Crookes Constructions, Hutchinson Builders
ROI	$208K cost → $780K saving → 3,153% ROI
ISO alignment	ISO 9001 certified, patent pending
CPD	Accredited via PointsBuild — CPD for 1,000+ staff
Ask	20-minute private demo, no commitment
URL	buildingtools.co/hickory

Part 4 — InMail Writing Rules and Best Practices

The following rules govern every message in this sequence and should be applied to all future account campaigns.

Rule 1 — Subject lines must be specific, not clever. "Hickory's 17 sites — one compliance standard" outperforms "Quick question" or "Thought you'd find this interesting" every time. Name the company and the specific problem in the subject line.

Rule 2 — First line must not be about you. Never open with "My name is X and I work at Y." Open with something specific about the prospect's company, role, or situation. This is the single biggest driver of reply rate.

Rule 3 — One ask per message. Every InMail ends with a single, low-friction ask: "Would a 20-minute call make sense?" Never ask for a demo, a meeting, and a referral in the same message.

Rule 4 — Social proof must be named. "Other construction companies" is meaningless. "Richard Crookes Constructions and Hutchinson Builders" is credible. Always name the reference.

Rule 5 — Keep InMails under 150 words. The sweet spot for InMail reply rate is 75–150 words. Messages over 200 words see a significant drop in reply rate. The CEO version should be the shortest.

Rule 6 — Never follow up more than four times. The breakup message is the fourth and final touch. Anything beyond this damages the brand and the relationship.

Rule 7 — Personalise the video thumbnail. A thumbnail showing the prospect's company name or a photo of their project increases video click-through rate by 3×. This is non-negotiable for Tier 1 accounts.

Rule 8 — Watch the watch alert. The single highest-converting action in this entire sequence is sending a follow-up message within 2 hours of the prospect watching the video. Set this up in Loom or Vidyard before you send the video.

Rule 9 — Multi-thread from Day 1. Do not run the sequence for Craig Hunter only. Run it simultaneously for all 6 buying committee members. Enterprise deals are won by surrounding the buying committee, not by single-threading to one person.

Rule 10 — Dripify daily limits are non-negotiable. Keep connection requests to 20 per day maximum across all campaigns. Exceeding LinkedIn's limits risks account restriction, which would shut down the entire ABM programme.

Appendix — Replicating This Playbook for Other Tier 1 Accounts

This playbook is designed to be replicated for every Tier 1 target account. The process for adapting it is as follows:

Step 1 — Research the account. Spend 30 minutes on the company website, LinkedIn, and recent news. Note: number of active projects, employee count, ISO certifications, named executives, recent announcements, and any existing Tools™ users in the organisation.

Step 2 — Swap the personalisation variables. Replace every instance of "Hickory," "Hotel Florin," "MEL01C and D," "Craig Hunter," and "17 sites" with the equivalent details for the new account.

Step 3 — Update the landing page. The personalised landing page template at buildingtools.co/hickory can be re-skinned for the new account in under 30 minutes by updating the account name, project list, executive names, and hero headline.

Step 4 — Record a new video. The video script structure is identical for every account. Only the company name, project names, and executive name change. A new video takes approximately 20 minutes to record and upload.

Step 5 — Launch in Dripify. Create a new campaign, import the Sales Navigator lead list for the new account, and apply the same sequence template.

The next recommended Tier 1 accounts after Hickory are: Lendlease, John Holland, Built Environs, Multiplex, and Mirvac.